

Submittal Tracker: Beta Tester Outreach Strategy

This document outlines the strategy for finding and approaching beta testers for the **Submittal Tracker** platform when you do not have an existing network of local professionals.

Core Value Proposition

For the Submittal Tracker, you are not selling "AI magic." You are selling **peace of mind, organization, and preventing schedule delays**.

Electricians, Plumbers, and GCs all share a universal nightmare: a submittal gets buried in an architect's inbox for 4 weeks, the material order gets delayed, and suddenly the entire project schedule is derailed—all because someone forgot to follow up on an email.

Here is how you frame the ask to acquire your first 5-10 beta testers:

1. The "Kill the Excel Spreadsheet" Approach

Everyone currently tracks these in a messy, color-coded Excel spreadsheet that is never up to date. Target that pain point directly.

LinkedIn / Cold Email Template:

"Hey [Name],

I'm a local developer here in [Your City]. I've been talking to a few guys in the trades who are constantly getting burned by delayed materials because a submittal got lost in an email chain or buried in a messy Excel log.

I built a lightweight 'Submittal Tracker' dashboard specifically to replace those messy Excel sheets. It gives PMs a clean dashboard to instantly see exactly what's approved, what's pending with the architect, and what's overdue.

I'm looking for 5 Project Managers or Estimators to use it for free and just tell me what sucks about it. Would you be open to letting me show you a quick 2-minute demo to see if it's something you'd even use?"

2. The "Subcontractor vs. GC" Angle

Subcontractors (like Electricians) often feel like they are at the mercy of the General Contractor's massive, clunky software (like Procore). They want their *own* lightweight system to make sure *they* are covered and have proof of submission.

The pitch to local Electrical/Mechanical PMs:

"Hey [Name] - I built a Submittal Tracker specifically for subcontractors who need their own clean system to track approvals, rather than relying on the GC's massive clunky software. If you're currently tracking your submittals in Excel, I'd love to give you free access to this tool in exchange for your brutal feedback on how to make it better."

3. Leverage "Show, Don't Tell" (The Dashboard Video)

A video is your best friend. Record a quick Loom video, showing off the **Command Center UI**.

- Show them the clean dashboard.
 - Show them how easy it is to filter by "Overdue" or "Revise and Resubmit."
 - **The message:** *"Look how much cleaner this is than your current Excel spreadsheet."*
-

4. Where to Find Testers (No Warm Intro Needed)

You don't need a warm intro. Construction tech is booming, and PMs are always looking for an edge to make their lives easier.

- **LinkedIn Search:** Search for "Electrical Project Manager" or "Mechanical Project Manager" . Filter by your local area first (people love helping local startups, and it gives you a personal connection).
- **Local Builders Exchange / AGC:** If you have a local builder's exchange or AGC (Associated General Contractors) chapter, look at their member directory. It's a goldmine of local electrical and mechanical contractors you can reach out to directly.
- **Reddit Communities:** Post in `r/estimators` or `r/construction` .
 - *Sample Post:* "Hey guys, I built a lightweight Submittal Tracker to replace messy Excel logs. I need a few PMs to beta test it for free and give me harsh feedback on the workflow. Anyone want to try it?"

You are offering to solve a massive headache (managing submittal statuses and keeping track of deadlines) for free. You will absolutely get bites if you frame it as asking for their "industry expertise" to refine the tool.